

Over the last few years, the Bangladesh team has been inconsistent in its performances. Why is that so?

In red-ball cricket, there is still a lot to be done. After playing Test cricket for 24 years, the fact that we still talk about improvement is not a pleasant situation.

I sometimes feel ashamed that, even after two decades, we haven't accomplished much.

However, it's important to understand that back home, ODI is the No. 1 format. If we truly want to succeed in Test cricket, the Board and team management need to act accordingly.

There are coaching staff members who come to work in Bangladesh for hefty salaries, knowing that if they can win two ODIs and a few T20Is, they'll be set. If that's the mindset, it's a problem.

Now, the question is: where does this mindset come from? It stems from the people running the Board. Everything needs to align if we want to tick all the boxes.

Over the last decade, the BCCI has appointed former Indian cricketers as head coaches, and now Sri Lanka has brought in Sanath Jayasuriya. Should the BCB consider appointing former Bangladesh cricketers as head coach as well?

I don't believe anyone in Bangladesh is currently capable of becoming the head coach. At the moment, there are two or three who are capable of becoming assistant coaches, but I don't think they are suited for the head coach role.

There should be a 70:30 ratio in Bangladesh's coaching staff, where you have an overseas head coach and perhaps two foreign coaches, while the remaining 70 per cent of the assistant coaches should be from Bangladesh. This approach would help groom local coaches so that, one day, they can step up as head coach.

There is a buzz that Bangladesh might get a new head coach soon. According to you, what should be



Crown jewels: Tamim Iqbal on his equation with Shakib-Al-Hasan: "I believe if our relationship had lasted longer, it could have been a game-changer for Bangladesh cricket." AFP

the criteria for becoming the head coach of the team?

Bangladesh should stop chasing big names, as not all well-known figures make good coaches for the team. They need to identify candidates who are suitable for Bangladesh cricket. The individual should be hardworking and able to add value to the team.

Is Ryan Ten Doeschate a massive name in world cricket? Yet he is still part of India's coaching staff. We need people like him who will work behind the scenes.

Is Abhishek Nayar a world beater? So why did the BCCI offer him the role of assistant coach? It's because he has something to contribute to the team. From what I have heard, he has done incredibly well with several teams and has worked closely with many Indian cricketers. We need to find such people instead of focussing on big names.

What are the areas that need to change for Bangladesh cricket to grow?

If you truly want to advance Bangladesh cricket and bring about change, the entire system needs to

transform. Will you achieve success in two years? No. It may take five years or even longer, so patience is essential.

Some aspects in Bangladesh are fine, but most need to change. I made my debut in 2006-2007, and as we speak in 2024, not a single new training facility has been developed in Dhaka over the past 17 years.

The funniest thing is that when the BCB claims to have Rs 1200 crore in its bank account, it feels like a slap in the face. There shouldn't be 1200 crore sitting idle; there should be 200 crore in the account, and the remaining 1000 should be invested in developing infrastructure. If you ask any corporate entity, they would tell you that reinvesting is the way to go. Did the BCB reinvest? No. And if they claim they did, then where are the facilities? Where is another stadium in Dhaka apart from the one in Mirpur? You definitely need a facility like Mirpur, and while I'm okay with playing to your strengths on certain pitches, it's crucial to produce quality wickets at the domestic level as well. This way, you can test your cricketers and prepare them for the international stage.